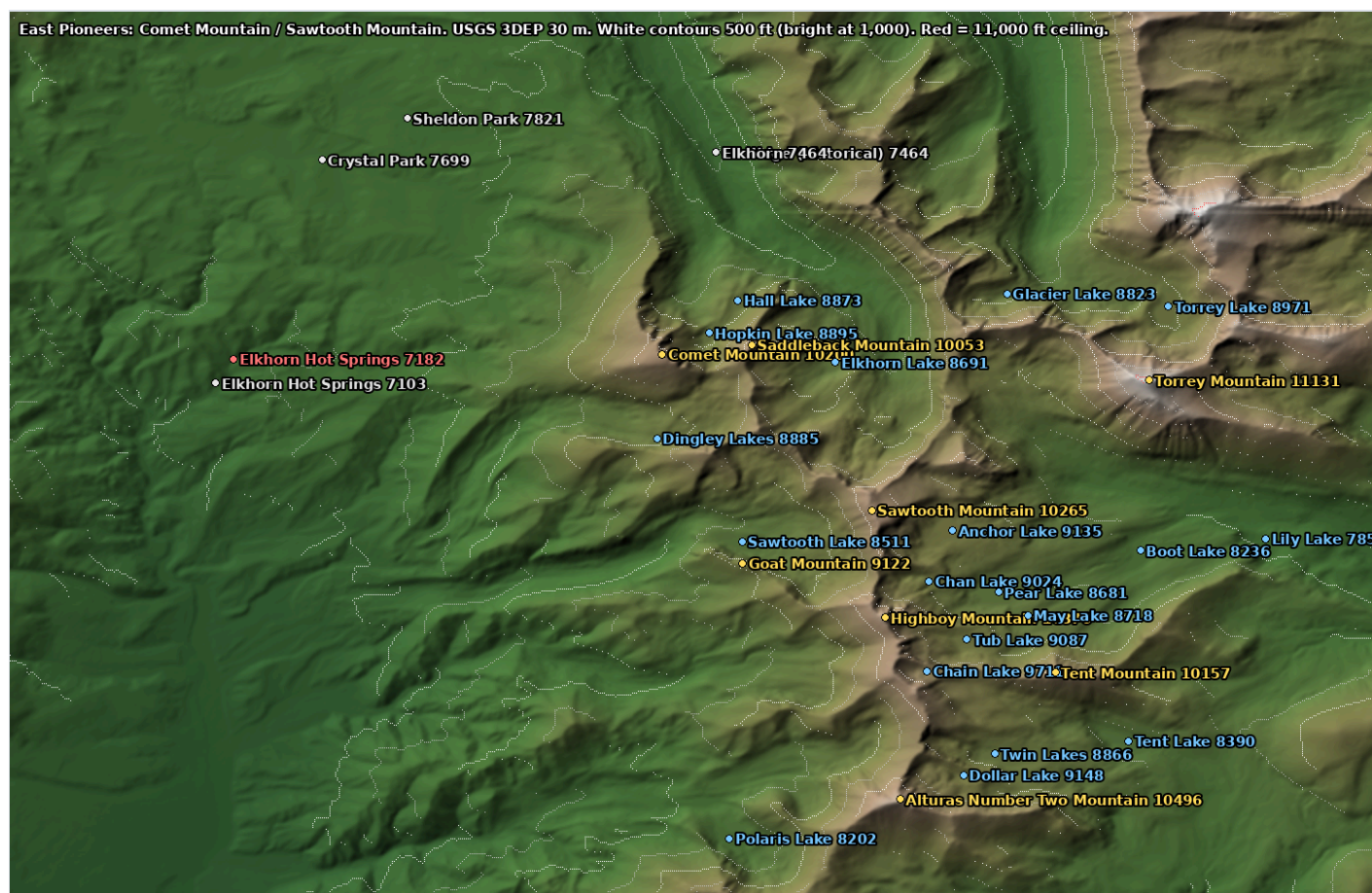


Comet Mountain and Sawtooth Mountain

East Pioneer Mountains, Beaverhead County, Montana. Everything in the project run against this one area: USGS elevation, roads, trails, railroads, buildings, cemeteries and names; Posey's stated rules; his map; the book; and the poem. September 14, 2026.

The short version. Both summits and every lake pass the elevation ceiling. The crest is national forest. A mapped road climbs Comet's west shoulder to 9,540 ft, 0.43 mi below the summit, so Comet and its cirque lakes sit inside the one-mile rule; Sawtooth Lake, Hall, Elkhorn, Glacier and Torrey lakes do not. No mapped buildings, graves or rails near any point, but Coolidge ghost town and the Elkhorn Mine, 2 mi north, bring ruins, adits and patented claims. The area is 94 mi from the nearest Fenn site, outside the walked-back 75 mi. The poem attaches at 'ursa east' (east of Polaris), at the hot springs, at the granite cirques, and, as an analyst reading, at Comet for 'what lives in time'. It does not attach at the Hole, the bride, the gates or the foot of three. Land ownership below is from test data; load the real PAD-US and re-score before trusting the public-land rows.

THE GROUND



USGS 3DEP 30 m. Contours every 500 ft, red at 11,000 ft. Torrey Mountain is above the ceiling; nothing else is.

EVERY NAMED FEATURE, SCORED

Rules as set in the constraint map: road within 1 mi (kill), hike over 300 ft (flag), trail over 500 ft (flag), slope under 30° (kill), below 11,000 ft (flag), Fenn radius 75 mi (flag). Distances from USGS National Transportation Dataset; buildings and cemeteries from USGS Structures (none within 5 mi of any point, so those columns are omitted).

FEATURE	ELEV FT	SLOPE	LOW-CAR ROAD, MI	ANY ROAD, FT	TRAIL, FT	FENN, MI	VERDICT
Comet Mountain Summit · 45.4597, -113.0443	10,200	8.0°	0.38 unnamed · local road	2004	5846 Comet Ridge Snowmobile	94	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Sawtooth Mountain Summit · 45.4368, -113.0136	10,265	25.3°	1.38 unnamed · local road	7298	5181 Clark Creek	92	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Hopkin Lake Lake · 45.4628, -113.0375	8,895	0.0°	0.72 unnamed · local road	3776	5252 Elkhorn Creek	94	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Anchor Lake Lake · 45.4338, -113.0017	9,135	0.0°	0.83 Birch Creek Rd · local road	4362	3128 Boot/Pear/May-Chain	92	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Saddleback Mountain Summit · 45.4611, -113.0312	10,053	33.2°	1.01 unnamed · local road	5317	3556 Elkhorn Creek	94	KILLED road_max, slope · flags: fenn
Hall Lake Lake · 45.4676, -113.0333	8,873	0.0°	1.02 unnamed · local road	5371	3745 Elkhorn Creek	94	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Chan Lake Lake · 45.4263, -113.0052	9,024	8.1°	0.69 unnamed · local road	3660	3507 Birch Creek/Boot/Anchor- Pear	92	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Dingley Lakes Lake · 45.4473, -113.0451	8,885	0.6°	0.76 unnamed · local road	4026	13291 Wise River-Elkhorn Hot Spring	94	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Sawtooth Lake Lake · 45.4322, -113.0326	8,511	0.0°	1.95 unnamed · local road	10320	529 Clark Creek	93	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Goat Mountain Summit · 45.4290, -113.0326	9,122	6.5°	2.04 unnamed · local road	10753	1677 Clark Creek	93	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn

FEATURE	ELEV FT	SLOPE	LOW-CAR ROAD, MI	ANY ROAD, FT	TRAIL, FT	FENN, MI	VERDICT
Highboy Mountain Summit · 45.4210, -113.0117	10,376	21.8°	1.02 unnamed · local road	5409	3839 Pear-May-Tub Lake	92	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Pear Lake Lake · 45.4247, -112.9950	8,681	0.0°	0.19 unnamed · local road	994	837 Birch Creek/Boot/Anchor- Pear	91	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Elkhorn Lake Lake · 45.4585, -113.0190	8,691	0.0°	1.61 unnamed · local road	8507	501 Elkhorn Creek	93	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Tub Lake Reservoir · 45.4178, -112.9996	9,087	0.0°	0.62 unnamed · local road	3250	579 Pear-May-Tub Lake	91	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
May Lake Lake · 45.4214, -112.9907	8,718	0.6°	0.2 Birch Creek Rd · local road	1055	393 Pear-May-Tub Lake	91	FLAGGED · flags: trail, fenn
Chain Lake Swamp · 45.4132, -113.0055	9,711	1.6°	1.04 unnamed · local road	5509	2705 Pear-May-Tub Lake	91	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Boot Lake Reservoir · 45.4309, -112.9742	8,236	0.3°	0.12 Birch Creek Rd · local road	646	631 Birch Creek/Boot/Anchor- Pear	90	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Coolidge (historical) Populated Place · 45.4894, -113.0364	7,464	6.8°	0.01 unnamed · local road	69	588 Elkhorn Creek	95	FLAGGED · flags: road_min, fenn
Tent Mountain Summit · 45.4130, -112.9867	10,157	14.8°	0.62 Birch Creek Rd · local road	3298	2318 Pear-May-Tub Lake	90	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Torrey Mountain Summit · 45.4558, -112.9730	11,131	11.5°	1.43 Birch Creek Rd · local road	7563	5080 David Creek	91	KILLED road_max · flags: elev, fenn
Glacier Lake Lake · 45.4686, -112.9938	8,823	3.9°	2.45 unnamed · local road	12913	3378 David Creek	92	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Twin Lakes Lake · 45.4010, -112.9956	8,866	0.3°	1.54 Birch Creek Rd · local road	8134	5943 Tent Lake	90	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn

FEATURE	ELEV FT	SLOPE	LOW-CAR ROAD, MI	ANY ROAD, FT	TRAIL, FT	FENN, MI	VERDICT
Dollar Lake Lake · 45.3979, -113.0002	9,148	0.8°	1.83 Birch Creek Rd · local road	9656	7112 Estler Lake	91	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Lily Lake Lake · 45.4326, -112.9559	7,851	3.3°	0.24 Birch Creek Rd · local road	1258	1231 Birch Creek/Boot/Anchor- Pear	90	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Alturas Number Two Mountain Summit · 45.3943, -113.0095	10,496	15.1°	2.25 Birch Creek Rd · local road	11885	6984 Polaris Lake	91	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Torrey Lake Lake · 45.4667, -112.9701	8,971	0.0°	2.14 Birch Creek Rd · local road	11275	1071 David Creek	91	KILLED road_max · flags: fenn
Tent Lake Swamp · 45.4029, -112.9760	8,390	0.2°	0.75 Mule Creek Rd · local road	3943	970 Tent Lake	90	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Sheldon Park Flat · 45.4944, -113.0817	7,821	1.4°	0.7 unnamed · local road	3717	5051 Wise River-Elkhorn Hot Spring	97	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Elkhorn Hot Springs Spring · 45.4590, -113.1072	7,182	4.0°	0.03 Pioneer Mountains Scenic Byway · local road	152	140 Old Hot Srpings Trail	97	FLAGGED · flags: road_min, trail, fenn
Crystal Park Flat · 45.4883, -113.0942	7,699	3.4°	0.24 unnamed · local road	1254	1234 Wise River-Elkhorn Hot Spring	97	FLAGGED · flags: fenn
Elkhorn Hot Springs Populated Place · 45.4555, -113.1098	7,103	8.6°	0.01 Pioneer Mountains Scenic Byway · local road	62	669 Grasshopper Ridge Ski	97	FLAGGED · flags: road_min, fenn
Polaris Lake Lake · 45.3886, -113.0345	8,202	0.0°	2.21 unnamed · local road	11692	365 Polaris Lake	92	KILLED road_max · flags: trail, fenn
Polaris Populated Place · 45.3696, -113.1195	6,350	2.6°	0.02 Billings Creek Rd · local road	86	5834 Grasshopper Inn-Res Lk #B	95	FLAGGED · flags: road_min, fenn

RULE OVERLAY, 47 SQ MI BOX



Box -113.10 to -112.96, 45.40 to 45.50. Red: killed.
Orange: flagged only. Green: none, because the Fenn flag covers the whole box.

- **Killed: 24.9 sq mi**, almost all by the one-mile road rule (21.9), the rest by slope (10.0, overlapping).
- **Flagged only: 22.1 sq mi**. Switch the Fenn rule off and this is the surviving ground: the west slopes from Crystal Park and Elkhorn Hot Springs up to Comet's shoulder, and the Birch Creek side around Boot, Pear, May, Chan and Anchor lakes.
- **Within the survivors, off any trail by 500 ft**: Comet's shoulder and summit, Hopkin and Hall lakes' bowl, Dingley Lakes, Anchor and Chan lakes.

POSEY'S STATEMENTS AGAINST THE AREA

STATEMENT	HERE	
Below 11,000 ft	Comet 10,200; Sawtooth 10,265; every lake 8,200–9,700. Torrey Mountain, 2.4 mi east, is 11,131 and out.	PASS
Publicly accessible, not private	The crest is Beaverhead-Deerlodge National Forest. Not verified with real PAD-US here (test data only). Coolidge and the Elkhorn Mine sit on patented claims that may be private; Elkhorn Hot Springs is a private resort.	OPEN
Free, 24/7	National forest: yes. Crystal Park charges a day fee (verify): not the site. The scenic byway closes north of Elkhorn Hot Springs in winter; access 'would be possible' still holds from the Wise River side.	PASS
Dogs	National forest: yes.	PASS
Not near a man-made trail	Comet summit 5,846 ft from the nearest mapped trail; Hopkin Lake 5,252 ft; Dingley Lakes 13,291 ft; Sawtooth Lake 529 ft from Clark Creek trail; Elkhorn Lake 501 ft; May Lake 393 ft (flag). Snowmobile routes cross Comet Ridge.	PASS
Not more than a mile from the car; a hike required	An unnamed mapped road reaches 9,540 ft on Comet's west shoulder, 0.43 mi from the summit. Hopkin, Dingley, Anchor, Pear, Boot, Tub, May, Chan lakes are all within a mile of a mapped road. Sawtooth Lake, Hall Lake, Elkhorn Lake, Glacier Lake and Torrey Lake are more than a mile from any road and fail the rule as set.	PASS
No high-clearance vehicle	The USGS dataset calls the Comet shoulder road a local road, not a 4WD road. That is the single most important thing to check on the ground.	OPEN
Not near buildings	No FEMA building footprint within 5 mi of any point. Coolidge's ruins are not footprints in that dataset and stand 2.1 mi north of Comet.	OPEN
Not near graves	No cemetery within 5 mi in the USGS structures data.	PASS
Not at railroad tracks	No rail within 5 mi today. The Montana Southern Railway ran to Coolidge until the 1930s; only the grade remains.	PASS
Not in a cave, mine or tunnel	GNIS carries no mine points any more. The Elkhorn Mine and its adits are around Coolidge. Anything within 500 ft of a working fails.	OPEN
No climbing required	Summit slopes 8° (Comet) and 25° (Sawtooth) on the 30 m grid; Saddleback 33° fails. Lake basins are flat.	PASS

STATEMENT	HERE	
Inside the printed map	Yes. Polaris (7.2 mi) and Dillon (26 mi) are two of the map's odd-one-out labels.	PASS
Within 75 mi of a Fenn search site	94 mi to Hebgen Lake, 110 to West Yellowstone: outside. Soft flag only; he walked the remark back.	FLAG
Not Colorado or Oregon	Montana.	PASS
Something must be manipulated to see it; nothing visible from 15 ft	Cannot be mapped. Field checklist.	OPEN
The book	Polaris and Crystal Park are named outright; the Grasshopper Valley chapter describes a 'star-spangled' sky and 'thumbing through your mental Rolodex for constellations'; Crystal Park 'smell of pine and wet granite'.	PASS
Crowd	This is the Polaris / Crystal Park zone the community has worked since 2025; 'within two miles' fits here. No correct checkpoint photo has been sent.	OPEN

THE POEM AGAINST THE AREA

LINE	WHAT IS HERE	
1:1 Can you find what lives in time	Comet Mountain. A comet lives in time: it comes back on a schedule. Analyst reading, not his.	fit?
1:3 Wisdom waits in shadowed sight	The Wisdom River (Big Hole) is 23 mi west; the east side of the crest drains to it through Elkhorn Creek and Wise River.	weak
2:1 As hope surges, clear and bright	Elkhorn Hot Springs, 3.05 mi west. The pool is private; Hot Springs Creek is not.	fit
2:2 Walk near waters' silent flight	Hot Springs Creek, Elkhorn Creek, or the Elkhorn Creek trail beside the creek to the lakes.	fit
2:3 Round the bend, past the Hole	Nothing named Hole within 8 mi. The Big Hole is 15 mi west, Wise River 8 mi east; neither is walking distance from the springs. This is the line the area does not answer.	open
2:4 I wait for you to cast your pole	Two dozen trout lakes; or the pole star, Polaris, 7 mi SW.	fit
3:1 In ursa east his realm awaits	Polaris is the star of Ursa Minor. East of the town of Polaris is this range: the East Pioneers. The most literal reading anywhere on the board.	fit
3:2 His bride stands guard at ancient gates	Nothing named for a bride or a gate in GNIS within 8 mi. Coolidge's mill and the Elkhorn Creek mouth are the only gate-like features.	open
3:3 Her foot of three at twenty degree	Twin Lakes (two), Dingley Lakes (plural), three cirque lakes under Comet (Hall, Hopkin, Elkhorn). No named three.	open
3:4 Return her face to find the place	Needs the bride.	open
4:1 Double arcs on granite bold	Pioneer batholith granite. Sawtooth Mountain carries twin cirques (Sawtooth Lake west, Anchor Lake east); Comet carries its own pair (Hall-Hopkin north, Dingley south). Two bowls on granite is a candidate reading to test from the summit.	fit?
4:2–4:4 secrets of the past, beyond time's reach, wonder guards	Coolidge and the Elkhorn Mine are the 'past' here, but they bring buildings, adits and private claims, which the rules exclude.	open
5:1–5:4	No geography.	–

WHAT WOULD KILL IT

- Real PAD-US putting Comet's shoulder or the lake basins inside a patented claim (private).
- The Hole having to be walking distance from the surge: nothing here is.
- The bride being identified far from the Pioneers.
- The shoulder road being a 4WD track: then Comet and its north cirque fail the one-mile rule and only the Birch Creek lakes remain.

CHEAPEST TESTS, IN ORDER

1. Drive the unnamed road off the Elkhorn Hot Springs side toward Comet. Note where a low car stops and the elevation there.
2. Load the real PAD-US GeoPackage and re-score candidates A to F.
3. From Comet's summit, photograph both cirque pairs and judge whether they read as double arcs.
4. Check Crystal Park's fee and hours. If it charges, it is not the site.
5. Walk Elkhorn Creek trail from Coolidge to Hall and Hopkin lakes and note every adit, ruin and marker within 500 ft of the water.

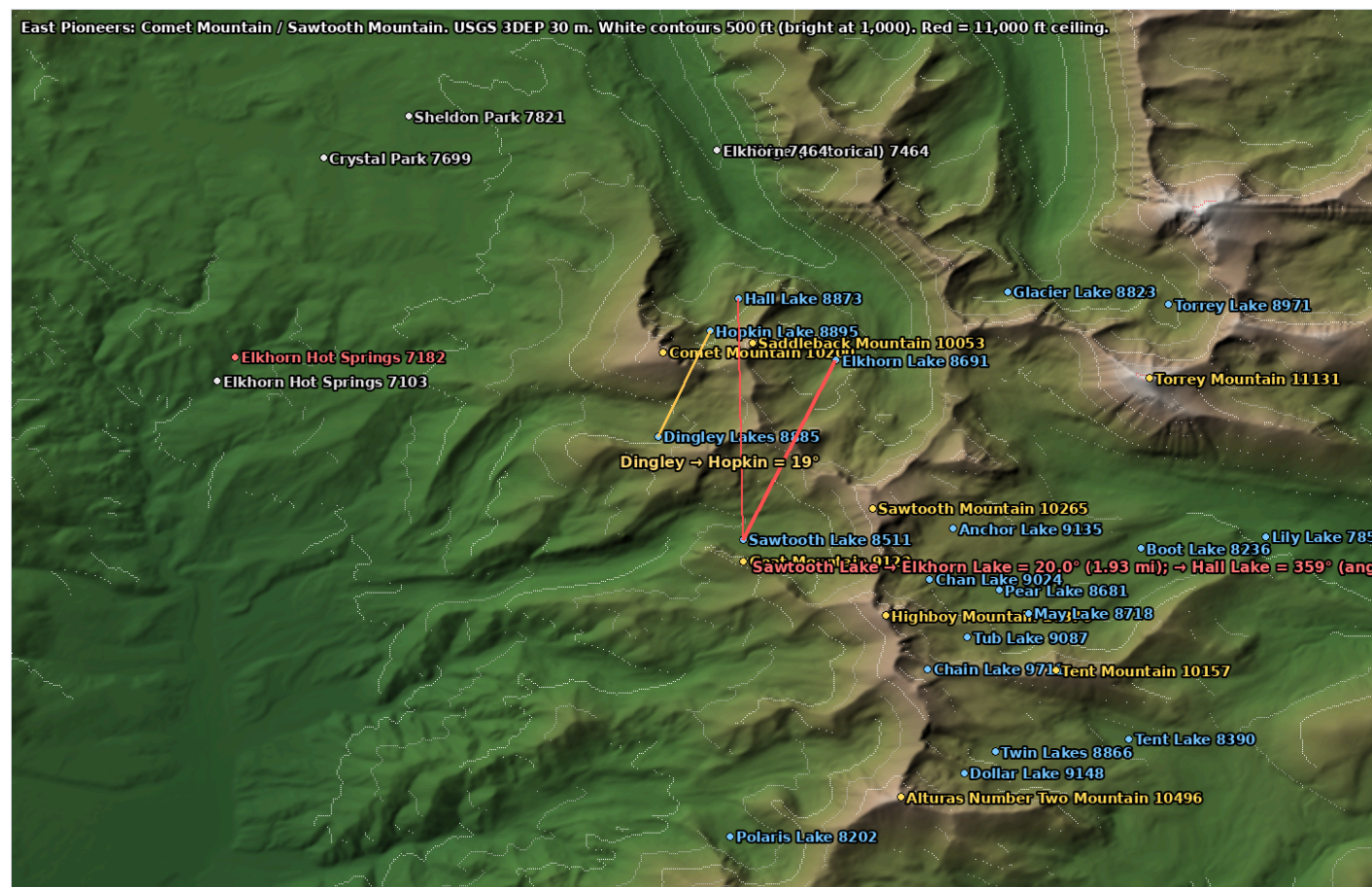
6. Ask the monthly Featured Question: is the Hole a valley?

COMMUNITY CLAIMS FROM REDDIT, UNVERIFIED

Screenshots supplied Sep 14 2026, from the r/beyondthemapsgedge thread "Narrowing in on...", posts from 2025. None of this is from Posey. Each is recorded in the research database as a community claim.

CLAIM	WHO	WHAT IT WOULD MEAN HERE	CHECKED?
Sawtooth Lake is the location of a 2020 Instagram photo of his tagged "Polaris"	Hydrofoiling, 8 upvotes	Puts him at Sawtooth Lake before the hunt; ties "Polaris" to this basin in his own tagging	Not verified against Instagram
In the book, fishing Grasshopper Creek, he "cast his pole" at a badger	deleted user, 3 upvotes	The poem's phrase in the book's own words, on the creek west of these peaks	Book page not cited
Comet Mountain and Coolidge are the only places with photos of Justin, Brandon and Tucker together; "his Grandpa had a place" here; he brought Tucker up from Texas	incomesharks (OP), 22 upvotes	Sentiment and lore at the site, which he has said the finder will come to know. If the grandfather's place is within a mile of a spot, the rules exclude that mile	Unverified; the place is not located
Three mountain lakes, at "the foot of the lake where their creeks start", form a perfect 20° angle; completing the triangle goes up the mountain, "almost exactly 5,200 feet, a mile from where you park"	incomesharks (OP)	A foot-of-three construction in this basin	Tested below on NHD outlets
Acknowledgements acrostic AFT TT AFT, read as Tweedy / Torrey and the chapter "Grasshopper Valley"	incomesharks (OP)	A hidden pointer to the East Pioneers	Not verified against the book
Comet Mountain is eroded and boulder-strewn: "it has literally lost its face"	Ok_Oil_2550	A face to "return", if the bride is the mountain	Reading, not a fact

THE 20° GEOMETRY, MEASURED ON LAKE OUTLETS



Red: the centre-to-centre line Sawtooth Lake → Elkhorn Lake (20.0°). Yellow: Dingley Lakes → Hopkin Lake. Only the yellow line survives when outlets replace centres.

What holds

- Lake OUTLETS were derived from USGS NHD flowlines for the two basins (Beaverhead and Big Hole). The "foot" of a lake is its outlet.
- **Dingley Lakes outlet → Hopkin Lake outlet bears exactly 20.0° at 1.27 mi** (200.0° back). The line climbs Comet Mountain's south-east flank to 9,807 ft at 0.75 mi, then drops to Hopkin's outlet at 8,896 ft under Comet's north cirque.
- Both outlets are within a mile of the end of the shoulder road: Dingley 0.86 mi, Hopkin 0.90 mi. That matches the post's "a mile from where you park".
- Comet's summit sits 0.85 mi from the Dingley outlet on a bearing of 3.9°, so the 20° line passes just east of the summit.

What does not

- The centre-to-centre hit Sawtooth Lake → Elkhorn Lake (20.0°) vanishes on outlets. Lake centres are not feet.
- Dingley Lakes has a plural name but is one mapped pond with one outlet. The "three" is not answered by counting lakes there.
- Base rate: 19 outlet triples within 3 mi meet at 20° ± 1.5°, and 118 centre triples within 8 mi. A 20° hit is expected by chance in a basin with 25 lakes. Geometry alone cannot choose; the bride and gates have to.
- The post's own words: "this next part is a stretch."

COULD ICE BE "WATERS' SILENT FLIGHT"?

For

- Ice and the melt under it move without sound; a frozen lake or snowfield is water in silent motion.

Against

- There are no glaciers in the East Pioneers today; "Glacier Lake" is a name. Snow cover changes by month, and he has said the

- The crest holds late snow on north faces above 9,600 ft: about 1.2 sq mi of such ground in the box, two thirds of it on Torrey Mountain, the rest under Alturas, Highboy, Sawtooth, Tent, Saddleback and Comet.
 - "As hope surges" would then be the spring melt, which fits the hot-spring-free east side.
- clues stand the test of time and are solvable from home.
 - Posey has said this leg is walking distance; a snowfield leg only exists part of the year.
 - A reading that survives every season: a "flight" is a series, as in a flight of steps or locks. The Boot, Pear, May, Tub and Chain lakes are a flight of water down one valley, and Chain Lake says so by name. That keeps the line time-proof without ice.

Verdict. Ice is possible but seasonal, which cuts against two of his statements. The chain of lakes is the stronger reading of the same idea, and it points at the Birch Creek side of Sawtooth Mountain.

SAVED IN THE TOOLS

Constraint map candidates A to F: Comet shoulder, Hopkin/Hall cirque, Dingley Lakes, Sawtooth Lake, Anchor Lake, Coolidge. Field HQ candidate: Comet Mountain / Sawtooth Mountain with the chain above. Both Montana and Wyoming layers are loaded in the constraint map, plus NHD water bodies for the Beaverhead and Big Hole basins.